

Price Watch

The latest up-to-date prices of all the gadgets you want to buy this month

Killer Rigs

We have a combination of PC configurations for most budgets out there, including the combo of our test rig

Smartwatches

More than telling the time, these smart wrist devices are more than just a one trick pony, and are well and truly vying for your hard-earned cash. Should you buy one?

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If there's one category of products that really announced themselves to the world in 2014, I have to pick the category of smartwatch. These handy devices are like companion gadgets to go along with your smartphone, and they let you keep your phone within the pocket (within Bluetooth range) by delivering notifications right to your wrist. Paired with your phone, smartwatches can help you get over your smartphone addiction by notifying you about incoming calls or SMSes without you having to whip out the handset every single time. That's not all, as most smartwatches also come with extra features like letting you control music playback on your smartphone, and some offer fitness features to help you out with your workouts. That's pretty much what most smartwatches are capable of doing right now. Not very smart now, is it?

One of my biggest beefs with smartwatches selling in the market currently is to do with their look and feel. Apart from, say, the Motorola Moto 360, none of the true smartwatches can be passed off as a plain old watch on your wrist. Most look like contraptions straight off a sci-fi movie (Mr India's invisibility device, remember?), and clearly not something you'd want to wear to work or in a professional environment. Geek chic is great, but you don't want to be confused with



C-3PO's cousin based on that ultra funky smartwatch on your wrist now, do you?

Another thing to watch out for in smartwatches is the fact that their platform is still very young and not clearly defined. For e.g., among smartwatches running on Google's Android Wear OS, LG G Watch R and Moto 360 are the two clear favourites to buy right now. Having said that, the Android Wear platform is awfully barren with respect to third-party apps that you can fire up on these smartwatches, and you're stuck with a chosen few apps to play with right now. To mention some other good smartwatches to buy -- off the ones available in the market right now -- would be Pebble, Apple's Watch, Samsung Galaxy Gear, and Sony's SmartWatch 3. Like I said, the field is barren right now when it comes to dependable purchases from well-known brands. I would've loved to indulge in the world of fitness bands and wrist-based health trackers here, but the fact that they're so numerous and full of independent tracking and sensing methods that they'd require their own page in this section some time in the future. And I also feel that some of the features that fitness

bands try to offer are incorporated within all the good smartwatches that are worth their salt in the market anyway.

There's no doubt that smartwatches are here to stay, whether you like it or not. And it's only a matter of time before traditional watch companies, big or small, make the deep dive into the world of smart wrist devices. However, the landscape is still emerging, and these are undoubtedly early days in the evolution of smartwatches. I

advise treading with caution, not getting easily swayed with e-commerce website discount deals and splurging on smartwatches unless you really really want them. Because most of these devices are either too infantile in their utility value, or Star War-ish in their appeal, and sport clearly exaggerated price tags that make absolutely no sense whatsoever -- seriously, I look at smartwatches sold online and get a mild heart attack everytime I see at their inflated prices. As I see things, a good old traditional watch packed with features like chronometer, barometer, altitude meter, water resistance, etc are cheaper compared to these new-age smartwatches which are hopeless on their own (meaning, if they're not paired with your smartphone) and can't last more than a few days without having to recharge them. Clearly, in my book, based on the evidence so far, the modern smartwatch isn't smart enough just yet. I have no doubt that 2015 will debut some interesting smartwatch concepts or iterations that will raise the bar even higher on last year's products, and your wrist (not to mention your bank balance) will ultimately thank you for your patience. 